

Chapter

Love or Burden? — The Truth About Rajasic Parenting



Introduction: Look Within Yourself

Every parent loves their child. But does our love sometimes become a burden for the child? In this short discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji paints a picture of how **rajasic** mothers raise their children — an upbringing driven by rajoguna, that is, by desire, ambition and the urge to show off.

Rajoguna — one of the three qualities (gunas) of nature (sattva, rajas, tamas); it is restless activity filled with desire and craving for results.

At the very start, Acharya Ji makes clear that this is not limited to mothers of any one age, and he makes a request of the listener:

"A mother remains a mother, doesn't she — thirty years, forty years — does she change? So how does she raise her child with a rajasic tendency? **Make sure you are not like this somewhere — check all of that.**"

And the word "mother" includes the father too:

"Mother means the father is included in it — that concept is understood."

Pressure Sitting on the Child's Head

The first mark of a rajasic mother is constant pressure on the child:

"What will a rajasic mother do? **All the pressure on the children** — look at all this on the time-table, the 'Work hard' photo, inspiration — 'Work hard', whatever it may be. In it there is going to school, doing this, doing that."

"Constantly she will sit on top of his head."

And the real goal behind all this is not the child, but the mother's own ego:

"And what will the aim be? **'My son is the topper, so I am somebody.'**"

High Expectations and the Craving for Results

The nature of rajoguna is the desire for results. Acharya Ji says:

"Their expectations are often high — very much so. **She wants some result.** And they may become upset if their children do not meet them."

Without considering what the child is capable of, the load just keeps growing:

"Whether the child has that much capacity or not, nobody knows; still — put him in classes, put double, put triple."

And alongside runs constant comparison:

"Such mothers often compare their children to others. Always — 'This one went in the exam, we'll see next time.' 'Someone said something at this function; at the next function we will do something different and show them.'"

Imposing Unfulfilled Dreams on the Child

Rajasic parents often place their own unfulfilled dreams on the child's shoulders:

"They will impose their ideas on their children: **'I could not do it, son, you will have to fulfil this dream.'**"

"'Oh, that was my childhood dream, my son will fulfil it!' Now after the son... **the son's passion will be something else altogether.** So by force — now he simply has to do it."

The Goat Being Led to the Butcher

In such a situation, with what heart does the child do that work? Acharya Ji gives a harsh but precise comparison:

"Now with how much interest will that child do it? **He sees his own death there.**"

"There is a goat, or some such creature, being dragged along by a rope... and the butcher is saying, 'Now I am going to run a little knife over your head.' So with how much enthusiasm will it go? **With just that much enthusiasm these children listen too, because they are small, they can't do anything.**"

Money and Name — the Only Reason to Choose a Profession

In a rajasic upbringing, even the choice of career is made not from the child's interest but from money and fame:

"Such mothers may push their children towards material success or fame, which can lead to **stress and anxiety in children.**"

"'Son, you must come first', or 'Become an engineer', because 'in such-and-such profession you get the most money.' That is why they will put him in that very profession."

"'Do this — do an MBA, or do this.' **Not because it is his passion;** because it brings the most money, or name and fame — that is why. That alone will be their reason for choosing a profession."

An Upbringing of Show: Social Media and Makeup

Acharya Ji draws special attention to a new trend of our times:

"Rajasic mothers may encourage their children to **look perfect on social media or in public** — for the photo."

In contrast, the sattvic mother's outlook is natural:

"The opposite of this is the sattvic mother. She says, 'Stay natural. He's a small child, he'll be however he is.' However he is doesn't mean just anyhow — a little decent, presentable is fine. **But that child is a child — let him be like a child!**"

Acharya Ji says this from his own experience:

"I have seen so many mothers — from afar, up close, everywhere. Full makeup on the child, the way film heroes and heroines do. 'He has to be in the photo, he's going to be on social media, he has to go to that function.' **Even real heroines don't wear that much makeup as they put on these children.**"

But he keeps a balance too:

"Oh, I am not saying don't dress them up."

Film Culture in Childhood

The real concern is the impressions being filled into children at such a young age:

"Telling them right from now to dance to film songs — **is that even their age? Do they even understand what the words are?** Those love songs... they will tell them to dance to those songs from the age of eight, even nine."

The reason lies in the parents' own lives:

"Because that is all their own life is filled with — the world, materialistic; **there is less of God, and more of this.** So on the child, from childhood — from watching serials over and over — dialogue, dance, clothes... all this must be happening in the homes of rajasic mothers."

The End of Rajoguna: Sorrow

What is the result of this entire upbringing? Acharya Ji warns:

"But later these very children leave these mothers or fathers and go away. Then, **searching for that love,** they either become promiscuous, or marry in the wrong place. This always happens."

"Or they become rebels and just run away. **They wait only to grow up, so that they can be free.**"

And in the end the mother too does not get what she wanted:

"So **the end of rajoguna — sorrow**. So in their reign too, what happens at the last? What the mother wanted, she mostly doesn't get. Even if she gets it, it turns out to be the wrong thing."

The same is stated in the Bhagavad Gita as the fruit of the three gunas:

**karmaṇaḥ sukṛtasyāhuḥ sāttvikam nirmalam
phalam
rajasas tu phalam duḥkham ajñānam tamasaḥ
phalam**

"The fruit of sattvic action is said to be pure; the fruit of rajasic action is sorrow, and the fruit of tamasic action is ignorance."

— Bhagavad Gita 14.16

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 Check yourself** — the rajasic tendency can be present in parents of any age; "mother" includes the father too.

- 2 The goal of rajasic parenting is not the child but the ego — **"My son is the topper, so I am somebody."**
- 3 High expectations, classes beyond the child's capacity and **constant comparison with others** become a burden on the child.
- 4 Do not impose your unfulfilled dreams on the child — **the child's passion may be something else.**
- 5 A child forced into work does it like **a goat being led to the butcher** — without any enthusiasm.
- 6 Making a child choose a profession only for money and name and fame breeds **stress and anxiety.**
- 7 **Let the child be a child** — show for social media and film culture at a young age rob them of their childhood.
- 8 In a home where there is **less of God and more of the world**, that is what passes into the children.
- 9 **The end of rajoguna is sorrow** — such children leave home in search of love, and the mother too does not get what she wanted.